Degarelix: hormone injections every 28 days

National Cancer Control Programme (NCCP) 00481 · Source reconciled draft; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending

PRACTICAL TREATMENT GUIDE

Practical treatment planning

Agree the arrangements with your oncology team.

STEP 1

Before starting

Full blood count, kidney and liver tests, blood glucose and a bone blood profile. Review heart disease, blood pressure, diabetes, mood, falls and fracture risk, sexual health, medicines and the treatment goal.

STEP 2

Taking or receiving treatment

A trained healthcare professional gives the injections under the skin of the abdomen. Injection sites are changed and kept away from pressure from belts or waistbands. This formulation is not given into a vein or muscle.

STEP 3

Tests and reviews

Repeat blood count, kidney and liver tests, blood glucose and bone blood profile when clinically indicated. Review symptoms and the injection sites. PSA, testosterone and scans follow the individual cancer plan.

STEP 4

Specific instructions

Book the next injection before leaving. If an appointment is missed, contact the team promptly for a new date; do not arrange an extra loading dose yourself. Degarelix does not produce an initial testosterone surge, so anti-androgen treatment solely for flare prevention is not normally needed.

STEP 5

Leaving with a clear plan

Confirm the exact next dose or appointment, duration and verified daytime and out-of-hours contacts.

Sources: NCCP 00481 v3: official regimen. Source reconciled draft; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending.